

New Horizons in Information Dissemination

The Radio Shack TRS-80[®] VIDEOTEX Private Network System

*A Low-Cost Data Communications Network Designed for Commercial,
Corporate and Private-Interest Applications*



TRS-80 VIDEOTEX — A Communications Breakthrough

In 1977, Radio Shack introduced the TRS-80 Microcomputer System, a product line that succeeded in bringing computer technology into the American home. In 1980, Radio Shack introduced another breakthrough in computer technology: TRS-80 VIDEOTEX, a low-cost information retrieval system.

TRS-80 VIDEOTEX gives people access to computerized information and services such as the latest news and stock reports, transportation schedules, electronic mail order marketing, and much more.

A subscriber merely connects a \$399 TRS-80 VIDEOTEX keyboard-terminal to a telephone jack and any television set (a \$29.95 software package is also available for use with personal computing systems). A phone call then puts the subscriber in touch with information providers located *anywhere* in the United States.

Now Any Organization Can Become An Information Provider

Radio Shack's new TRS-80 VIDEOTEX Private Network System makes it possible to disseminate your information *electronically*. And with systems starting at under \$10,000, it's not only easy — it's affordable. Just as important, TRS-80 VIDEOTEX is designed, built, and backed by a 1.6 billion dollar company — Radio Shack.

Proven in Actual Use

Unlike many other systems, TRS-80 VIDEOTEX is performance proven. That's because Radio Shack's TRS-80 VIDEOTEX technology was selected for use in the government's "Project Green Thumb" experiment. This system provided farmers with the up-to-date agricultural information they required to stay ahead in such a volatile industry.

Tomorrow's Technology Is Here Today With TRS-80 VIDEOTEX

Right now, your organization could be gaining valuable experience with the communications medium of the future. Because unlike other systems, the TRS-80 VIDEOTEX Private Network System is available *today* — not two years down the road.

What TRS-80 VIDEOTEX Means to You

With a TRS-80 VIDEOTEX Network System, your organization can establish a private or public information network. Services can range from your organization's newsletters, industry news, medical reports, agricultural news — virtually any information that requires up to the minute status.

Your organization can also generate commercial revenue by allowing advertisers to provide services. These services can range from consumer information, travel agency bookings, theater schedules with reviews, ski reports to sports results, mail order services and much more.

Internally, you can make your organization's data accessible to management personnel, no matter where they are located in the U.S. Information such as inventory, pricing and product descriptions could also be made available as a special service to your selected customers.

Your Network — As Seen by Your Subscribers

Subscribers will find TRS-80 VIDEOTEX easy to use — no computer experience is necessary. Information is requested by using the keyboard of the TRS-80 VIDEOTEX terminal. After dialing your network's telephone number, the information will appear on the subscriber's TV screen.

With the information now stored in the TRS-80 VIDEOTEX terminal, the network terminates the telephone call — automatically. The stored information displays, or "pages" can then be viewed at the subscriber's leisure.

Your subscribers can buy TRS-80 VIDEOTEX terminals at any Radio Shack. Or, you may wish to market TRS-80 VIDEOTEX terminals through your company. Either way, you — and your subscribers — will receive full support from Radio Shack.

Experience the Decade's Most Exciting Medium

Learn how to make tomorrow's technology work to your organization's advantage — with a TRS-80 VIDEOTEX Network System. For more information, contact Radio Shack's Special Markets Division today!

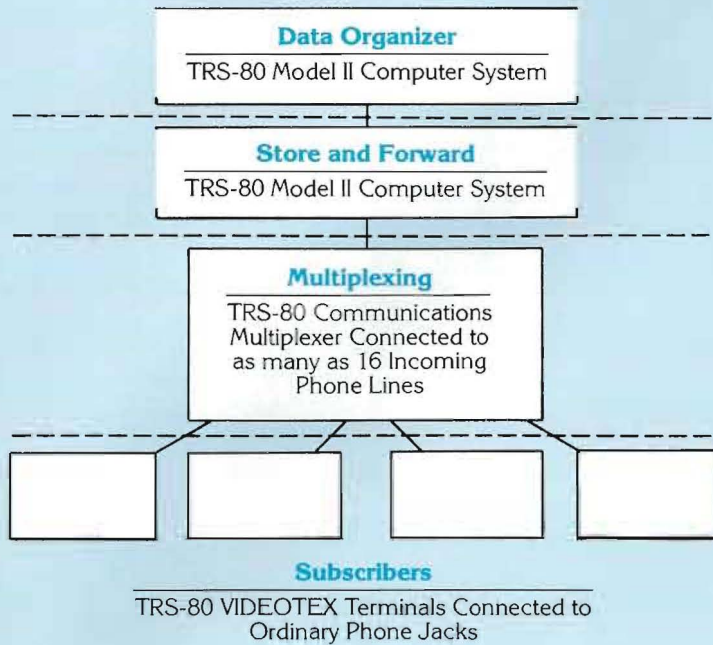


Radio Shack's TRS-80 VIDEOTEX Network is the fast, inexpensive way to reach people where they work or live. Across town, across the state or across the nation!

A Closer Look at the System Itself

From the basic system to larger, expanded systems, a TRS-80 VIDEOTEX Network can be divided into 3 areas: Data Organization, Store and Forward, and Multiplexing.

Basic TRS-80 VIDEOTEX Network Configuration



Typical system is capable of supporting about 100 subscribers per incoming telephone line. Subscribers can access up to ten pages of information in less than three minutes.

Data Organization

The data organizer consists of a TRS-80 Model II Computer with up to 33 megabytes of disk storage. It is used to update all of the information that is to be provided, which is entered into the system via the keyboard or from pre-recorded diskettes and stored by menu numbers. If desired, a modem can be added to accept information from outside sources over the phone lines.

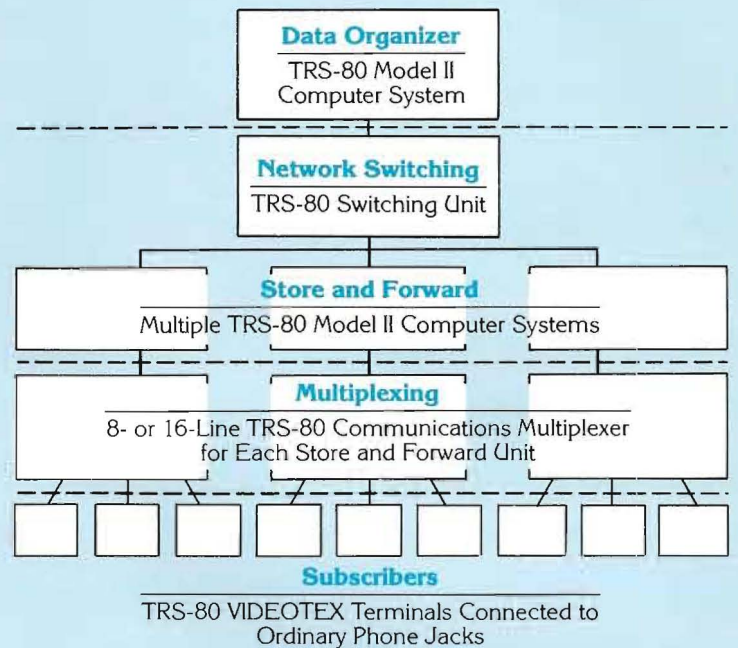


Store and Forward

The Store and Forward system is a dedicated processor that consists of a TRS-80 Model II Computer with up to 2 megabytes of disk storage. This system stores all of the user-accessible information. Working with the multiplexer, it also provides the necessary logic to respond to incoming phone calls, retrieve and forward information requested by a particular subscriber and terminate the call. And it does it all automatically, without operator assistance.



Expanded TRS-80 VIDEOTEX Network Configuration



Systems are available with either 8-line or 16-line multiplexers. Network switching permits multiple Store and Forward systems to be used to serve a larger number of subscribers.

Multiplexing

Multiplexing refers to the data communications process that permits numerous users to share a common resource. In a TRS-80 VIDEOTEX network, a TRS-80 Communications Multiplexer is used to service up to sixteen subscribers simultaneously. It is connected to the communications port of the Store and Forward Model II and to standard incoming telephone lines. These lines typically use a single phone number on a rotary system to transfer incoming phone calls to the first available line.



The TRS-80 Communications Multiplexer is available in two versions. One version accepts eight incoming phone lines, while another version designed for larger networks can accept up to sixteen lines. Assuming each user accesses eight pages of information a day, about 100 users can be supported on each phone line. Under these conditions, a sixteen-line system could service up to 1,600 subscribers.

Expanded Systems

If greater capacity is required, additional Store and Forward systems and multiplexers can be used. In such expanded systems, a TRS-80 network switching device is used to direct communications from the Data Organizer to the various Store and Forward systems. These systems can be located near the Data Organizer or connected by phone lines from remote locations. This allows subscribers in other cities to access your system with a local phone call.

The Revolutionary New TRS-80 VIDEOTEX System From the Computer Innovators at Radio Shack

Leave it to Radio Shack to design a truly cost-effective data communications system. After all, it was Radio Shack that put "big-computer" power into a low-cost system that fits on a desktop.

The Biggest Name in Little Computers

We're the world's largest manufacturer of small computers — and your number one choice in small, privately-owned networks as well. Already, thousands of our TRS-80 VIDEOTEX Terminals are being used by the general public.

These terminals are being used by people who have one common trait: they all have a need or desire for obtaining timely information. Whether it's up-to-the-minute news, the latest stock reports or current weather reports, this information is available to TRS-80 VIDEOTEX users from large databanks.

We're Setting New Standards in Data Communications

Now, with the Radio Shack TRS-80 VIDEOTEX Private Network System, virtually any organization can set up a databank that lets people access your information. Unlike bigger systems, a TRS-80 VIDEOTEX is incredibly easy to implement and use. And, it's much more affordable.

TRS-80 — A Tradition of Quality and Support

Every TRS-80 VIDEOTEX system is made in the USA by Radio Shack. Each system is thoroughly tested to meet our

strict quality standards before it leaves our manufacturing facilities.

Each system comes with complete documentation — from thorough systems manuals to quick reference sheets. And you get the full support of our Special Markets Division in Fort Worth, Texas. There's also a toll-free "hotline" for fast, convenient technical assistance.

Leasing — An Alternative to Purchasing

Want to help your cash flow? Our 39-month lease is a convenient way to get started with a TRS-80 VIDEOTEX Network. It's complete with an option to buy at the end of the lease, too.

The Finest Service Anywhere

When it comes to service, Radio Shack offers not one, but two service plans. Our in-shop plan is the most affordable, and covers all parts and labor. You simply bring your equipment by any Radio Shack — we take care of the rest.

In many areas, our on-site plan provides service at your location. During regular working hours, all parts, labor, mileage and expenses are covered. We also include installation and scheduled preventive maintenance.

Discover the Future With Radio Shack

We will continue to be pioneers in the computer industry. With our TRS-80 VIDEOTEX Network System, you can pioneer the medium of the future — electronic information!

Technical Overview

Data Organizer

TRS-80 Model II Microcomputer with Three-Disk Expansion Unit

Microprocessor: 4-MHz, Z-80A.

Memory: 64K.

Disk Storage: One internal and three external 8" double-density floppy disk drives, for a total of 2.0-megabytes. Expandable with up to four hard disk drives for over 33-megabytes of on-line storage.

Keyboard: 76-Key keyboard with numeric keypad.

Video Display: High-resolution 12" monitor.

External Connections: One standard parallel printer port, two RS-232C serial ports, one external disk bay port.

Power: 120VAC, 60 Hz. U.L. listed.

Dimensions: 14x21 1/4x23 1/2" (HWD).

Store and Forward Area

TRS-80 Model II with Two-Disk Expansion Unit and Special Network Software

Specifications same as Data Organizer except for:

Disk Storage: One internal and two external 8" double-density floppy disk drives for a total of 1.5-megabytes. Expandable.

Software: Special Network Management Tools.

Multiplexer

TRS-80 Communications Multiplexer

Microprocessor: 4-MHz, Z-80A.

External Connections: 50-pin RJ21X Telephone Jack, Two 9600-baud RS-232C Serial Ports.

FCC Approval: #AA099R-68793-DM-R.

Ringer Equivalence Number (REN): 0.7B.

Power: 120VAC, 60 Hz. U.L. listed.

Dimensions: 13x20x26" (HWD).

Subscriber Terminals

TRS-80 VIDEOTEX Terminal

Microprocessor: 4-MHz, Z-80A.

Memory: 4K model stores eight "pages" of information, 16K model stores 16 pages of information.

External Connections: Modular phone jack, TV adapter.

Power: 120VAC, 60 Hz. U.L. listed.

Dimensions: 3 1/2x13 3/4x14 3/4" (HWD).

Radio Shack
The biggest name in little computers™

A DIVISION OF TANDY CORPORATION

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